Robotic Media Was Just the Beginning.

Physical AI Media Is the Category.

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Born from the past.
Built for the future.

Two weeks ago I wrote about Robotic Media. I called it a new category, the first form of media native to autonomous physical systems. I still believe every word of it.

But while I was writing that piece, I was also building the company that operates inside it. And the more we built, the more I started seeing something larger. Robotic Media is real. It's also the first chapter of something bigger. The category that contains it, the category nobody has named yet, is Physical AI Media.

I want to name it now, before someone else does, and explain why it matters more than the obvious read suggests.

What is happening, and what is missing

Physical AI is no longer a niche conversation. Jensen Huang puts it at the center of every NVIDIA keynote. Fei-Fei Li built World Labs around it. Sequoia published a thesis paper on it last year. The robotics community, the AI community, the venture community, all of them now agree: the next computing platform will not be a screen. It will be a body. It will be a fleet of bodies. Robots, drones, autonomous vehicles, embodied agents that move through the physical world and make decisions in it.

That part is consensus.

What nobody is talking about is the economic layer on top of it.

Every computing platform in history has eventually developed its media layer. The internet became the internet plus internet advertising. Mobile became mobile plus mobile advertising. TV became TV plus TV advertising. The media layer is not optional. It's how the platform pays for itself, scales, and reaches the parts of the economy that the platform alone could never reach.

Physical AI has no media layer yet. There is no name for it. No taxonomy. No infrastructure. No standard. The category that will eventually be worth tens of billions of dollars currently does not exist as a named space.

I'm naming it Physical AI Media.

The definition

> *Physical AI Media is the layer that makes the rise of Physical AI economically sustainable. Every system that moves through the physical world becomes part of the same programmable, measurable media network.*

That's the line. Read it twice.

Concretely, Physical AI Media is the economic infrastructure that monetizes autonomous physical systems through a programmable, certified, and attributable media layer. It is the category that turns every autonomous system in the physical world, robots and drones and autonomous vehicles and embodied agents, into a native media node.

It is not DOOH. It is not robot advertising. It is not a new flavor of programmatic. It is a category of its own, defined by three things that do not exist in any other media today.

Three things that make this category structurally different

The first is how inventory grows. In every form of physical media that exists today, inventory grows linearly. To have more impressions, you install more screens. You sign more leases. You negotiate more locations. The unit economics are tied to physical real estate, and physical real estate scales the way buildings scale, slowly and expensively.

Physical AI Media inventory grows exponentially. Every new robot deployed in the world is new inventory. Every new drone, every autonomous vehicle, every embodied agent. McKinsey forecasts more than twenty million commercial service robots deployed globally by 2030. That number is also the inventory curve of Physical AI Media. We don't have to build it. The robotics industry builds it for us, because they're building those units for entirely different reasons, and the media layer just sits on top.

The second is how impressions are measured. Today's physical advertising runs on estimates. A panel says this location gets this many footfalls. A study claims this number of eyes per hour. Everything is a proxy. Nothing is verified at the moment of impression.

Physical AI systems have sensors. They have cameras, lidar, IMUs, depth perception. Those sensors exist because the robot needs them to do its job. They were not installed for advertising. But once they exist, they can certify every impression deterministically and in a privacy-compliant way. Who was in the field of view. For how long. At what angle. Under what lighting. We built the first version of this for our deployments in Rome, and the leap is hard to overstate. We are going from *trust the panel* to *verify the impression*. It's the same jump that took digital advertising from TV ratings to programmatic, twenty years ago. Now it happens in the physical world.

The third is the most strategic, and the one that took me the longest to articulate. The media layer is additive, not foundational. A billboard exists only to sell advertising. If it doesn't sell, it's a worthless asset. A digital display only earns when it serves an ad. The unit economics of all traditional out of home rest on advertising as the only revenue stream.

A robot is not a billboard. A robot delivers food, cleans floors, transports packages, welcomes guests, secures buildings. Its primary function justifies its existence. The media layer is pure upside. The robot works regardless. No advertiser means no advertising revenue, but the robot keeps generating value through its operational function. That changes the entire risk profile of the category. We are not selling advertising on assets that exist to sell advertising. We are adding a profitable layer to assets that already work.

These three properties, combined, don't exist anywhere else in media. That's why this isn't an evolution. It's a category.

Robotic Media, the first layer

This is the part where I have to be precise about credit and history.

Robotic Media exists. We named it. We have been building it for the past year. The first commercial deployments are live. The first manufacturer integrations are in production. Hundreds of thousands of certified impressions have been served. We have a manifesto, an operating system called TitanoOS, and a network of partners across multiple geographies.

Robotic Media is the first layer of Physical AI Media. It is the first vertical, the first proof of concept, the first piece of infrastructure to actually exist at scale. Robots came first because they are the most commercially mature form of Physical AI. They are deployed today, in airports, malls, hotels, hospitals, last-mile delivery. The infrastructure we built for Robotic Media, the certified impression engine, the programmatic stack, the integration SDK, will become the technical foundation for every other vertical of Physical AI Media that comes after.

That includes drone media, which is closer than most people think. Delivery drones operating over urban areas will need certified-impression infrastructure the day brands start paying for visibility along high-traffic flight corridors. It includes autonomous vehicle media, which is the largest single opportunity in the category. Tesla, Waymo, Cruise, the entire commercial logistics autonomous sector. Every Robotaxi, every autonomous truck, every passenger pod with a display surface or an interaction surface. It includes embodied agent media, the category that doesn't even have its products yet but will when humanoid robots become commercial within the next five years. Every humanoid that talks to a customer is also a media surface.

All of this inherits from Robotic Media. The technical decisions we are making now, the standards we are setting, the measurement framework we are codifying, they will be the inheritance of the entire category for the next decade.

That's why I want to name Physical AI Media now, while we are operating inside the first layer. Anyone can claim a category. The right to claim it belongs to the people already building.

The prediction

I'll put a date on the table.

> *By 2028, every commercial robotic deployment will include a media layer by default. The same way every website today includes analytics. Not as an option, not as an upgrade. By default. Built into the deployment from day one.*

I'm not pulling this out of the air. Three forces are converging right now. Manufacturer margins on service robots are getting compressed every quarter as the hardware commoditizes, and manufacturers are looking for software-based revenue to widen unit economics. Brand advertisers are running out of room in digital, hitting saturation in CTV, finding DOOH too rigid for the audiences they actually want to reach, and they are actively looking for new physical formats that combine reach with measurability. Sensor and connectivity costs have collapsed to a point where adding a media layer to a robot deployment is not a capital decision anymore, it's a software decision.

When those three forces meet, the media layer stops being optional. It becomes a baseline economic expectation. Exactly the way analytics became a baseline expectation for websites around 2008, after being an upgrade for the previous decade. We are now where web analytics was around 2005. The technology is ready, the demand is forming, the standards are starting to emerge. Three more years and the default flips.

That's the date I'm putting on this prediction. If I'm wrong, I'm wrong by a year or two on the timing. If I'm right, this article is the public record of who saw it first.

What comes next

I'm not going to pretend Titano can build every vertical of Physical AI Media. We can't. No single company can. What we are building is the infrastructure layer that the verticals will run on. We started with Robotic Media because that's where the deployments already exist commercially. The rest of the category will need its own operators, its own specialists, its own partners. We want to be the layer underneath all of it.

What I'd like, from anyone reading this who works in robotics, in adtech, in venture, in policy, is to start using the term. Not because I want credit, but because categories are real only when they have a name and the name gets shared. Physical AI Media is the name. The category is real. The infrastructure is being built. The first vertical is operational.

The category exists from today. We are at the beginning. Everything that comes after is open.

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